

KESTRA INSTALLATION GUIDE

Windows • macOS • Linux | Participant Pre-Workshop Setup

Goal: install Docker, launch Kestra locally, and access the Kestra dashboard at <http://localhost:8080>.

01 Download Docker

Visit <https://www.docker.com/products/docker-desktop/> and choose the installer matching your system.

Platform	What to download / install
Windows	Docker Desktop for Windows (AMD64 for most Intel/AMD PCs; ARM64 for ARM devices).
macOS	Docker Desktop for Mac: choose Apple Silicon or Intel.
Linux	Docker Engine for your distribution, or Docker Desktop where supported.

02 Install Docker

Windows: run the installer and keep the WSL 2 backend option enabled if offered. macOS: install Docker in Applications and open it. Linux: follow the official Docker Engine installation instructions for your distribution. Restart if prompted.

Windows prerequisite: hardware virtualization must be enabled; WSL 2 must be installed and up to date.

03 Start the Docker engine

Open Docker Desktop and wait until the engine reports that it is running. Linux Docker Engine users should ensure the Docker service is started. A Docker Hub sign-in is not required for this local workshop.

04 Verify Docker in a terminal

Windows: PowerShell. macOS/Linux: Terminal. Run both commands:

```
docker --version
docker info
```

Both should return Docker information. If docker info reports that it cannot connect to the daemon, start Docker and try again.

05 Launch Kestra locally

Keep Docker running. Copy the command for your operating system below. The first launch pulls the Kestra image and may take a few minutes.

Windows • PowerShell

```
docker run --pull=always --rm -it -p 8080:8080 --user=root `
  --name kestra `
  -v kestra_data:/app/storage `
  -v kestra_db:/app/data `
  -v /var/run/docker.sock:/var/run/docker.sock `
  -v /tmp:/tmp `
  kestra/kestra:latest-slim server local
```

Important: the backtick (`) is PowerShell's line-continuation character. Copy the complete block.

macOS / Linux • Terminal

```
docker run --pull=always --rm -it -p 8080:8080 --user=root \
  --name kestra \
  -v kestra_data:/app/storage \
  -v kestra_db:/app/data \
  -v /var/run/docker.sock:/var/run/docker.sock \
  -v /tmp:/tmp \
  kestra/kestra:latest-slim server local
```

Keep this terminal open while Kestra is running.

06 Open the Kestra UI

Open a web browser on the same computer and navigate to: <https://localhost:8080>

If Kestra prompts you to set up a local account, complete that screen. You should then reach the dashboard.

Troubleshooting

Problem	What to try
Docker engine not running	Open Docker Desktop; wait for the engine to start.
Windows WSL error	Open Administrator PowerShell, run <code>wsl --update</code> , then restart.
Virtualization error	Enable Intel VT-x / AMD-V in BIOS/UEFI.
Port 8080 in use	Stop the service using port 8080 before

	starting Kestra.
Container name already in use	Run <code>docker stop kestra</code> , then <code>docker rm kestra</code> if the old container remains.
UI does not open	Inspect the kestra container logs in Docker Desktop; check that the container is running.
Image pull slow	Allow Docker to finish downloading the image; check internet connectivity.

Stopping and restarting

To stop Kestra, press `Ctrl + C` in the terminal running the container. To restart, start Docker and run the same command from Step 5. The named volumes `kestra_data` and `kestra_db` preserve local data across ordinary restarts. Do not delete them unless you want a reset.